

Working-session *synthesis*

Meeting #3 · June 9, 2026 — the record we can always return to.

Meeting #3 · Monday June 9, 2026 · 5:27 PM Present: Pedro, Mario, Munchie, Tony (joined mid-session) **Absent:** Elliott, Justin **Format:** Recorded working session, intended to be fed back into the canon knowledge repo.

TL;DR

The session locked the summer around three concrete initiatives — a college visit, an overnight team-building trip, and a ballgame — and worked out the operational and legal scaffolding to run them safely. The college visit is the lead domino and now has a real timeline. Two work-streams got owners: Mario/Munchie own activating the young men and collecting their info; Pedro owns the application, the parent-consent stack, and the donation site. The LLC is approved; banking, the gift-receipt process, and signature discipline are the near-term financial to-dos. Everyone agreed the fundraising posture is "invite people in," not "ask for charity," and that the site has to *show the work* (photos, testimonials) to actualize donor value. Governance settled into a small decision-making board with a wider collaborating committee, and a default-on recurring Tuesday cadence.

1. Knowledge infrastructure (framing)

Pedro opened by reframing the canon repo as the group's "knowledge wealth": meetings get recorded, fed in, and auto-versioned so nothing is lost and no single person carries it all in their head. The near-term vision is that the committee can eventually *talk* to the repo — drop ideas or capture assigned tasks from their phones while out and about — and pull artifacts on demand (e.g., spin up a presentation for a prospective donor). Tony was tapped to help tidy the mechanics so Pedro isn't the bottleneck.

Pages already standing: the **vision one-pager**, the **strategy/game plan**, and the **plan of activities** (key dates + active work). The repo holds more than the pages surface; the pages are curated views of the larger record. Mario to read the one-pager and flag anything missing.

2. Summer initiatives

Three initiatives are on the table for the summer. The college visit leads; the trip is the heaviest lift; the ballgame is the easy trigger held in reserve.

2a. College visit (lead initiative)

Discussed – Format choice: skip the big **open house (June 26, ~4–5 hrs)** in favor of a **general daily visit** — more intimate, student-guided campus tour, faculty access if you arrive early, and lunch. The open house breaks into discipline-specific tracks, which suits older students who already know their major; this cohort skews younger (sophomores rising to seniors) with mixed interests, so the general visit fits better. Discipline-specific visits are a "next year" move. – Candidate schools: **Illinois State** (provides lunch, strong general visit), **U of I** (feeds you only on the morning session), and a campus referenced as Oakland State (student-led tour). Weekend dates are scarce — Illinois State has very few; most visits wind down by **~August 10** for the summer. – Adjacent idea to monitor (not added to scope): **trade-school exposure** (IBEW / plumbers' union and similar) and an **IT day** at Pedro's office, so the young men see technical and trades paths alongside college.

Decisions / parameters – Target window: the **week after July 4th**, a **weekday** (Mon July 6 onward); float the **July 7–9** range and let the young men pick. – Hard constraints: **July 26–Aug 1 off-limits** (cohort traveling to Washington); one school date (Fri the 21st) unavailable. – Logistics: be **on the road by ~6:30 AM** (on campus before 9). Expect **~5 young men; 1–2 adult drivers / 2 cars** covers 6–7 riders.

Timeline – This Thursday (June 11): **no basketball** (neighborhood fest; park is taken over). – **Thursday June 18:** float the visit to the young men at the gym; frame it as a real commitment. – **Now → June 18:** Mario/Munchie pre-collect phone numbers via group text to expedite confirmations. – **By June 25:** confirmations in. – **By June 26:** lock the date and call the school.

2b. Summer trip (overnight, team-building)

Discussed – The point is twofold: a shared *activity* plus **unstructured time** for organic connection — the same dynamic that makes hooping work, where the unplanned moments next to a young man are where the real mentorship happens. – Location ideas raised: **White River, WI** (lodging + canoeing), the **Michigan dunes** (forest, campgrounds, bonfire — Tony's pitch; the drive itself is part of the experience), and caves/cave-dwelling. Criteria: somewhere with activities *and* downtime conducive to just being around each other.

Decisions / parameters – Everyone researches and brings **1–2 location options** to the next meeting. – Target timing: **early August**, roughly a month after the college visit, before school resumes. – This is the **most expensive** of the three; cost is still open (see §6).

2c. Ballgame (held in reserve)

Discussed – White Sox is the natural fit (Boston series coming up). Also referenced: Elliott's first-responders game (fire vs. first responders, "Chicago Heat") at the Sox stadium, with some of the young men already attending. Venue (Comiskey vs. Rosemont) unconfirmed. – Low cost and low friction: ~\$30/ticket, roughly **\$500–\$700** all-in; summer break makes scheduling easier; meetup is the park.

Decision – **Let the first two initiatives land, then slot the ballgame.** It's an easy trigger and can even roll into the fall (a Bulls game is the fallback).

3. Scholarship application & minor protections

This was the most substantive operational thread. Mario raised the real question: how do we handle the difference between the **18+ young adults** (one is college-bound to Northern) and the **minors**, especially since the committee is effectively *third-party* to most of the parents — they know the young men from the gym but haven't met most families.

Pedro takes the lead on drafting two online forms plus the supporting research:

1. **Scholarship application** (online form).
2. **Parent/guardian consent form** (online form) — plus research into exactly what's legally needed.

The consent stack for the overnight trip (highest stakes, since it's out-of-city and overnight): – Guardian consent – Travel consent – **Emergency medical authorization** — so a chaperone can authorize treatment if the guardian is unreachable – Allergy / medication / insurance information – Designated chaperone list with supervision expectations and a basic code of conduct

Insurance flag: the overnight trip is the activity most likely to fall *outside* whatever the LLC's coverage includes. Pedro flagged this as worth a direct phone call to verify, not an assumption.

Tone with parents: put a couple of committee numbers on the page for questions (a retired-CPD committee member was named as a natural contact), and remind parents the committee is at the gym every Thursday. Mario noted the formality itself *adds legitimacy*. Approach: introduce yourselves at the park, keep it light and routine — an "assumptive close" that feels like a normal school sign-up rather than something unusual.

Data-hygiene note (carried forward): This synthesis intentionally omits the young men's names, ages, and any contact details, consistent with the principle that minor PII does not belong in shared repos. Before any of this is committed to canon or rendered to HTML, confirm that no minor identifiers travel with it. The collected info (names, numbers, consent details) should live somewhere access-controlled, not in the markdown record or the public site.

4. Young men's info-collection form

Separate from the formal application, Pedro will stand up a **light intake form**: basic contact info plus a **short prompt** ("here's what we're thinking — what are your thoughts?") — explicitly *not* an essay. The goal is **co-ownership**: surface the young men's own ideas about what they'd like to do. Mario can collect on paper and Pedro transposes, or the young men fill it in on their phones.

5. Legal & financial structure

LLC: Approved / done.

Banking (near-term): open the **Chase LLC account**. – Likely single-member / sole-name (Mario), which can be done online; adding other names requires going in. – **EIN:** unresolved whether one is required — check whether Chase requires it; if so, obtain from the IRS online. – **Taxes:** track simply — revenue in, costs out, via the bank ledger.

Signature & fund discipline (protects personal assets): – Sign as "**Mario Ramos on behalf of La Familia Community Scholarship LLC**" on all documents/check-ins, so the LLC is the actor, not Mario personally. – **Pull all funds from the LLC account** for anything purchased, and keep receipts. This is the single most important habit for clean accounting and liability separation. – Declarations / meeting minutes / formal hierarchy are good practice but rarely enforced — treat as a slow burn.

6. Gifts vs. donations (this year's posture)

This first year, money coming in is treated as **gifts, not tax-deductible donations** (no 501(c)(3) yet).

- Each contribution should be documented as a **gift** — a simple signed acknowledgment (an online form works: "I'm giving \$X to La Familia Community Scholarship as a gift").
- **Gift-tax threshold:** under **\$15,000** per giver carries no liability; above that triggers tax. All current givers are trusted family/friends who gave directly to Mario.
- Going forward, capture intent at the point of payment: have donors type "**gift**" in the Zelle memo (it's optional today, so prompt for it) or check a box on the eventual donation form.
- **Open:** decide whether to apply this retroactively to gifts already received, or only going forward.

501(c)(3) path: start as the LLC, then **roll into a nonprofit** later. A trusted contact ("Tammy") who has run one for ~15 years has offered to walk Mario through it; it's a ~6-month-to-a-year process with real paperwork. Plan: get the feet wet this summer on family/friends gifts, meet Tammy after the summer, then pursue nonprofit status to unlock **corporate donations** (businesses want the write-off) — a stated **goal for next summer**.

7. Donation site & fundraising philosophy

Mindset (agreed): This is **not** asking for charity — "not Jerry's kids." It's inviting people to *be part of* something beautiful and successful. The frame is **co-ownership**: people want in. Tony's own eagerness to join was cited as proof of the pull.

Pedro's social-entrepreneurship funnel — treat it like a business with a social return instead of profit. Three things, nothing more: 1. **Find your customer / make it crystal clear what we're doing**. 2. **Enable the contribution** (payment path). 3. **Actualize the value** — show the fruits: photos and short videos from the visits, testimonials from the young men and from third parties.

Site status & plan – The informational front-end already exists in the repo; Pedro can have the AI generate the public site largely from canon. He needs the committee to send **color/font/design references** (sites they like) to steer look-and-feel. – **Mobile-first** — the majority of constituents will view on phones (tablets work, just less optimized). – Practical idea: capture content *at* the college visit so the site has real proof before the bigger asks. – A guardrail Pedro flagged: capture value at events (photos, testimonials) **without getting distracted from the mission** — presence with the young men comes first.

Whether to step up site rigor now: open question. If the three initiatives can be funded through known family/friends, a formal donation site isn't urgent. If a more public, self-serve ask is needed to fund them (especially the trip), the site becomes the priority.

Fundraising number: never formally set. Working estimates: college visit ~\$200–\$300 (gas), ballgame ~\$500–\$700, trip TBD (the big one). A target for the summer total is still an open decision.

Essence (recurring theme): "presence" is the core — being present with the young men across different walks of life. The cohort spans enough variety that every young man can relate to someone. The site language Pedro liked: *more than money, it's presence* — and the "front door" framing.

8. Governance & cadence

- **Board vs. committee:** a small **decision-making board** (the ~3–4 who've been in it — Mario, Pedro, Munchie, and Tony) stays accountable to each other and makes the calls. A **wider committee** can collaborate, contribute, and even take action items, but Mario

is accountable to the board, not to every opinion. This is the guardrail against scope creep and "too many cooks" — people arriving late with big ideas while things are already in motion.

- Mario will **open a group chat** to invite broader committee participation now that there's momentum, while keeping the core tight.
- **Cadence:** recurring **Tuesday** meetings, **default-on / opt-out**. Next meeting: **next Tuesday (June 16)**.

9. Action items

#	OWNER	ITEM	TARGET
1	Mario / Munchie	Float the college visit to the young men at the gym; frame as a real commitment	Thu June 18
2	Mario / Munchie	Pre-collect phone numbers via group text to expedite confirmations	Now → June 18
3	Mario / Munchie	Get visit confirmations	By June 25
4	Mario	Lock the college-visit date and call the school	By June 26
5	Pedro	Build light intake form (contact info + short "what do you think?" prompt)	Next meeting
6	Pedro	Draft scholarship application (online form)	Next meeting
7	Pedro	Draft parent/guardian consent form + research required consents/authorizations	Next meeting
8	Pedro	Verify LLC insurance covers youth activities, esp. the overnight trip (direct call)	Before trip commit
9	All	Research summer-trip locations; bring 1–2 options each	Next meeting
10	Mario	Open Chase LLC bank account; determine whether EIN is required	Near-term
11	Mario	Adopt signature protocol ("on behalf of LLC"); route all funds through LLC account + keep receipts	Ongoing
12	Mario/Pedro	Stand up gift-receipt process (form or Zelle "gift" memo); decide on retroactive application	Near-term
13	Mario	Meet Tammy on 501(c)(3) conversion steps	After summer
14	Committee	Send color/font/design references for the donation site	When site greenlit
15	Pedro	Generate donation site from canon (pending the "step up rigor now?" decision)	TBD
16	—	Hold the ballgame until the first two initiatives land	After visit + trip
17	Mario	Open committee group chat; keep core board tight	Near-term

10. Open decisions needing Pedro/Mario alignment

1. **Step up the donation site now, or stay on family/friends gifts for the summer?** Hinges on whether the trip can be funded informally.
2. **Summer fundraising target** — no number was set. College visit + ballgame are small and likely covered; the trip drives the real number.
3. **Retroactive gift documentation** — apply to gifts already received, or only going forward?
4. **Summer-trip location and dates** — pending research; needs to land before consent paperwork can be trip-specific.
5. **Application timeline** — the formal scholarship-application return window vs. the fundraising close is still an open Pedro/Mario decision (carried from prior sessions).

Addendum — Post-session refinements (June 13, 2026)

Sections 1–10 above are the record of the meeting as it happened on June 9. The decisions below were refined afterward in a Pedro working session while drafting the forms packet. Captured here so the team's recall artifact reflects current decisions, without altering the

meeting snapshot.

Consent & minor-protection decisions (refines §3): – **Background checks for chaperones — deferred to Year 2.** This year's trip is informal and limited to families the committee has existing relationships with, so background checks are not required for now. The **two-adult rule is retained** as the primary supervision control. When participation opens next year to young men the committee doesn't personally know, background-check rigor steps up. (*Canon reconciliation: the standing protection model in canon still lists background checks — mark it as a Year-2 requirement so canon and the forms don't drift.*) – **Emergency medical authorization — simplified.** Keep the authorization for a chaperone to approve emergency treatment if the guardian is unreachable, and keep collection of **allergies/medications/conditions** as safety information. **Drop** collection of insurance carrier/policy and primary physician. Add a **guardian-expense clause** stating that any costs of medical care are the guardian's responsibility (replaces the need to coordinate billing). – **Media handling — single signed term, not granular opt-in.** Tracking per-photo consent is unworkable, so the packet states that photos/video may be taken to document and promote the work, and the guardian consents by signing. Anyone wanting their child excluded raises it separately and the committee honors it. – **Committee contacts — TBD** until the team reviews and the initiative goes official.

Financial decisions (refines §6): – **Gift-tax threshold corrected:** the meeting's \$15,000 figure is stale. The federal annual gift-tax exclusion is **\$19,000 per recipient for 2026** (held from 2025).

Resolved open decisions (from §10): – **Donation site:** decision made — **build it, but keep it private/unlisted.** Informational pages can be public; the intake/consent/gift form endpoints stay behind a shared link rather than indexed, given the minor data involved.

Still open (carried forward from §10): – Summer fundraising target (no number set). – Retroactive gift documentation (paper prior gifts, or only going forward). – Summer-trip location and dates (pending research; needed before the trip-specific consent addendum can be finalized). – Scholarship-application return window vs. fundraising close (Pedro/Mario alignment).

Staged as plain-text markdown for review. On approval, this can roll into canon and — if desired — become a working-session HTML page in the established design system.